



# Soknarith (Soki) Sem

☎ (401) 952-6819 — ✉ [seminaia401@gmail.com](mailto:seminaia401@gmail.com) — 🌐 [Seminaia](#) — in [soknarith-sem](#) — 📍 Worcester, MA

## SUMMARY

Materials and process engineer with experience in process optimization, manufacturing support, statistical process control, SOP development, Lean/Six Sigma principles. Skilled in process scale-up, troubleshooting, CAPA implementation, and cross-team technical transfer. Proficient in data-driven analysis and modeling to improve process performance and product quality, with strong hands-on experience in lab and pilot-scale operations. Familiar with various scientific computing tools including Python, MATLAB/Simulink, ASPEN Plus Dynamics, and R for data analysis and process modeling.

## WORK EXPERIENCE

### Research Assistant / Graduate Teaching Assistant

May 2024 to Present

*Worcester Polytechnic Institute – Worcester, MA*

- Quantified defect energetics and transport behavior in oxide perovskites using DFT and thermodynamic modeling.
- Analyzed structure–property–process relationships across temperature and chemical potential regimes.
- Assisted in teaching undergraduate and graduate materials engineering courses by grading assignments and leading homework help sessions.

### Chemical Process Engineer

May 2023 to May 2024

*Knowles Precision Devices – New Bedford, MA*

- Led R&D-to-production transition for high-voltage capacitor dielectric fluids.
- Optimized manufacturing layout and process flow using LEAN principles and statistical process controls, reducing production costs by 15%.
- Authored SOPs and technical documentation for material handling and process scale-up.
- Performed root cause analysis on material-related failures, including deviation investigation and CAPA implementation.
- Modeled heater behavior in order to quantify the length of time required to reach target temperatures.

### R&D Technician

Mar 2023 to May 2023

*Factorial Energy – Woburn, MA*

- Fabricated Li-metal batteries in controlled glovebox and dry-room environments.
- Reduced material waste by 20% through inventory system redesign.

### Downstream Purification Engineer

Jul 2022 to Mar 2023

*Eurofins Scientific – Framingham, MA*

- Purified therapeutic proteins using AKTA Avant systems achieving 95–99% purity.
- Applied DOE methods to optimize buffer conditions and flow rate for maximum yield and purity at lab-scale.
- Performed lab-scale TFF membrane filtration and AKTA chromatography experiments to support pilot- and manufacturing-scale development.
- Characterized purified proteins using SDS-PAGE, HPLC/MS, GC/MS, UV-Vis, and related analytical techniques.

## EDUCATION

### M.S. Materials Science & Engineering

GPA: 3.50

*Worcester Polytechnic Institute – Worcester, MA*

2024 to 2026

### B.S. Chemical Engineering; B.S. Applied Mathematics

GPA: 3.16

*University of Rhode Island – Kingston, RI*

2019 to 2022

**Minors:** Chemistry, Physics

**Relevant Coursework:** Advanced Process Engineering, Polymer Chemistry, Polymer Engineering

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

**Atomistic Simulation:** DFT (VASP & GPAW), Molecular Dynamics (LAMMPS)

**Scientific Computing:** Python, MATLAB, ASPEN Plus Dynamics, Linux, LaTeX, R, Unicorn

**Laboratory / Analytical:** Glovebox, clean-room, HPLC, AKTA FPLC, TFF, SEM/XRD, DSC/TGA, UV-Vis, Osmometry, HPLC/MS, GC/MS, pH meter, SDS-PAGE, KF titration

**Process / Manufacturing:** SPC, DOE, Lean/Six Sigma, Process optimization, SOP development, Tech Transfer (MSAT), cGMP